

4.7 Shareaza

4.7.1 Introduction

This is a client that works on various P2P networks: Gnutella, Gnutella 2, eD2K, and BT, though it is positioned mainly as a Gnutella 2 client. It also incorporates a download manager.

4.7.2 Usage

After installation, Shareaza connects to the Gnutella 2 network automatically. While the number of connections seems small in comparison to eMule, the nature of the Gnutella network ensures that this is of little significance.

The Gnutella / Gnutella 2 protocol network is in the Hub and Spoke (or leaf) architecture. So connecting to two hubs means that one is indirectly connected to all the spokes in the hubs, and since some of these spokes are also connected to other Hubs, even those peer's shared files are accessible to you. The number of peers that are connected to you are displayed in the status bar. If needed, connections to the Gnutella network and eD2K network can also be made by clicking on the buttons bearing their names.

The Home interface is presented upon launch of the program. In this view, a summary of all the activities and status of the client can be had. The number of peers connected to, the downloads in progress, etc. are all mentioned. There is a search box which can be used to find content shared by other peers, which is the first step.

For greater control on the search process, the Search interface can be accessed by clicking on the Search button. You can specify which network to search in—eD2K or Gnutella or Gnutella 2. The search results are displayed in the application itself.

The range of the search is displayed under the search box, showing the number of hubs and leaves searched. Details about the files being shared by other peers are listed, along with properties of the connection, including the number of copies, speed of that connection, etc. It is best to select a file that has the higher Host / Count and the highest download rates. After selecting the file, one uses the context menu to download the file.

Shareaza can also be used to directly retrieve data from the shared folder of another peer using the Gnutella 1 or 2 protocol. For